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Summary

This Analysis Report investigates the use of Total Quality Management (TQM) concepts at Normanton Lodge Care Home, intending to improve the quality of care provided to residents. The article discusses the significance of TQM in healthcare and identifies existing quality measures in care homes, such as infection control, medication management, and individualised care. Despite these qualities, numerous difficulties are raised, including inadequate protection measures, weak governance, and poor staff communication. These issues slow down the care home from completely complying with TQM standards, especially in terms of leadership accountability, customer focus, and employee involvement.

To solve these problems, the article suggests implementing a variety of quality improvement strategies. For example, the PDSA (Plan-Do-Study-Act) cycle may be used to improve safeguarding and incident reporting, whereas Lean Six Sigma can assist improve care documentation and operational efficiency. The essay also recommends using ISO 9001 standards to standardize operations and promote consistent care delivery.

The paper indicates that by implementing a thorough TQM structure that includes leadership commitment, staff training, and regular input from residents and families, Normanton Lodge can achieve continuous improvement. This will not only improve care quality but will also provide a safer, more efficient, and resident-centered care environment.

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Introduction

Quality in healthcare involves objective and subjective characteristics to effectively meet consumers' explicit and implicit requirements (Alzoubi et al., 2019). Quality assurance, which is critical to healthcare's economic survival, is based on ethical, legal, and social rights, ensuring consumer satisfaction while minimising risks (Alzoubi et al., 2019). Modern healthcare is concerned with examining and regulating organisations, processes, and outcomes to maintain quality standards. However, the industry faces considerable problems, such as rising costs, rapid technological change, and increased demand for high-quality care in the context of complicated health conditions (Alzoubi et al., 2019).

This report analyses Total Quality Management (TQM) in healthcare, with a focus on strategic planning, continuous quality improvement, and performance management. It includes an examination of quality measures and models, resulting in a proposed improvement plan for Normanton Lodge Care Home, a residential facility for older adults, dementia patients, and people with sensory disorders, based on findings from a recent Care Quality Commission (CQC) inspection.

Department or Service and Quality Measures Overview

Maintaining great product quality is critical to succeed in the highly regulated and competitive medical device sector (Stanton, 2021). A Total Quality Management (TQM) approach may help ensure quality, compliance, and customer satisfaction (Stanton, 2021). By concentrating on fundamental TQM concepts, medical device manufacturers may involve all stakeholders (employees, leadership, and suppliers) to create an integrated approach to quality management (Stanton, 2021). This partnership guarantees that every stage of product development, from production to customer feedback, is consistent with the highest quality standards, establishing an excellent foundation for long-term success (Stanton, 2021).

Current Quality Measures at Normanton Lodge Care Home

Normanton Lodge has implemented several quality measures, including assessing residents' clinical risks, using infection control procedures, and ensuring competent care delivery standards. The CQC report states that residents' nutritional and water intake, meals were fattening, and pills were taken at the correct time. Staff encouraged independence, provided various activities, and helped maintain relationships. The hospital has been cooperative with external agencies for better care quality, ensuring a safe and effective environment for residents.

Alignment of TQM principles and Normanton Lodge Care Home

The examination of Normanton Lodge Care Home demonstrates weaknesses in Total Quality Management (TQM) principles.

Customer focus, prioritising patients' needs and improving communication among stakeholders to improve satisfaction and results (Stanton, 2021), is noticeably absent since the care facility failed to protect residents from potential abuse, jeopardising their well-being.

Leadership responsibility, essential for promoting TQM through effective governance and continuous improvement procedures such as the Deming Cycle (Stanton, 2021), is also lacking. The leadership at Normanton Lodge shows inefficient governance and a failure to learn from previous incidents.

Furthermore, employee engagement, which means including staff in the quality management process through clear policies and a supportive environment (Stanton, 2021), is an issue. The CQC assessment reveals a bad culture in which employees feel unable to express problems.

Finally, the lack of an organised, process-driven approach, often supplemented by a centralised electronic quality management system (eQMS) to eliminate errors and improve efficiency (Stanton, 2021), has resulted in discrepancies in care documentation at Normanton Lodge.

Addressing these TQM issues is critical to improving care quality, safety, and resident happiness at the facility.

Do Current Quality Measures Ensure Optimal Outcomes and Reflect TQM?

Normanton Lodge Care Home provides safe, efficient care with well-trained staff who are skilled in infection control, medication administration, and meeting the dietary and social requirements of residents. According to the CQC report, the facility adheres to several Total Quality Management (TQM) standards. TQM's emphasis on attending to residents' needs and supporting their well-being is in line with these initiatives. Nonetheless, governance and protection have limitations. Inadequate safeguards were discovered, and chances to gain knowledge from occurrences were lost. Furthermore, some employees complained of a bad work atmosphere that prevented genuine conversation. In keeping with TQM principles, quality and safety would be further improved by enhancing governance, protecting, and creating a more open, cooperative environment (The Investopedia Team, 2024).

Evaluation of Models and Frameworks Supporting the Analysis

The PDSA cycle is a quality improvement model that consists of four steps: Plan (develop an improvement plan), Do (implement on an initial scale), Study (review results), and Act (modify and expand successful improvements) (Jain, 2024). It promotes continual progress by implementing tiny, iterative adjustments (Jain, 2024). Normanton Lodge can apply the PDSA model to improve safeguarding and governance by planning a new reporting system,

implementing it on a small scale, studying its effectiveness, and adjusting as needed. This approach ensures continuous improvement in handling safeguarding concerns (Jain, 2024).

Lean Six Sigma combines Lean concepts, which emphasise waste reduction and efficiency, with Six Sigma procedures designed to reduce process variation and errors (Jain, 2024). It uses data-driven methodologies, process mapping, and statistical tools to determine the core causes of problems, optimise workflows, and achieve significant quality and performance improvements (Jain, 2024). Normanton Lodge can use Lean Six Sigma to improve care documentation and governance, resulting in fewer mistakes in daily care notes. This systematic method improves operational efficiency, making it easier to monitor care quality and conduct corrective actions effectively (Jain, 2024).

Effectiveness of Measures: Do They Work?

The recommended procedures for Normanton Lodge Care Home have a high potential for success. Safeguarding training improves employees' ability to identify and report misbehaviour, which is consistent with Total Quality Management (TQM) concepts. Improving leadership responsibility and encouraging open communication improves governance and morale (Peek, 2023). Implementing a centralised electronic quality management system (eQMS) streamlines operations, while continual staff training ensures that practices remain current (Lemay, 2022). Involving residents and families can increase overall care satisfaction.

However, issues such as staff resistance and resource constraints may impede implementation (Peek, 2023). Success depends on careful execution and ongoing leadership support (Peek, 2023). Overall, when correctly implemented, these methods have the potential to improve quality management greatly.

Analysis of Measures and Models

The flowing table will evaluate Normanton Lodge Care Home's continuing quality metrics, highlighting strengths and weaknesses in safety, effectiveness, and patient-centered care. This overview identifies significant areas for improvement and provides a foundation for using Total Quality Management (TQM) principles to improve care quality.

Measure	What does the company do?	Strength of the approach	Limitations of the approach
Safe	Follows infection control, manages medication safely.	Reduces health risks effectively.	Weak safeguarding and incident reporting increase resident risk.
Effective	Staff follow care plans; assess clinical risks.	Training supports effective care delivery.	Governance gaps leave some risks unaddressed.
Patient-centred	Promotes independence, activities, and personalized care.	Enhances dignity and individual care.	Communication with families and staff culture need improvement.
Timely	Maintains adequate staffing for prompt care.	Quick response builds trust.	Limited feedback channels can delay issue identification.
Efficient	Standardized routines; staff trained for roles.	Ensures consistency in daily care.	Weak governance slows issue tracking and resolution.
Equitable	Provides fair care to all residents.	Commitment to meeting individual needs.	Limited incident review affects care consistency.

Table 1 – Analysis of measures measures at Normanton Lodge's Care Home.

Adapted from author.

The analysis of Normanton Lodge's quality measures can be linked to the Total Quality Management (TQM) framework, specifically through the Plan-Do-Check-Act (PDCA) cycle for continuous improvement. For example, gaps in safeguarding and incident reporting could be addressed by following PDCA: Plan improvements in reporting, Do implement new processes, Check their effectiveness, and Act by refining these processes based on feedback.

Non-financial Models Analysis

The Balanced Scorecard (BSC) and SERVQUAL model are two commonly used frameworks that help businesses measure and improve quality, each with an individual focus. While the BSC provides a broad, organization-wide view (Tarver, 2024), SERVQUAL is exclusively designed to assess service quality (Bhasin, 2023).

The Balanced Scorecard (BSC) is a strategy tool that examines performance from four perspectives: customer satisfaction, internal processes, learning and growth, and innovation (Tarver, 2024). Unlike pure financial indicators, the BSC provides a more comprehensive picture of an organisation's overall health and effectiveness (Tarver, 2024).

The SERVQUAL approach is a method to assess service quality in customer-focused enterprises, measuring five key dimensions: tangibles, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy (Bhasin, 2023). It evaluates physical aspects like facility appearance, service consistency, response times, staff knowledge, and personalized care (Bhasin, 2023).

The SERVQUAL model is better suited for Normanton Lodge Care Home as it focuses on essential quality aspects of care environments, such as compassion, reliability, and responsiveness (Bhasin, 2023). Given Normanton Lodge's goals of providing a safe and supportive environment that prioritises residents' health, comfort, and well-being, SERVQUAL's emphasis on empathy, dependability, and responsiveness aligns closely with these objectives (Bhasin, 2023).

Multi-dimensional Models Analysis

Six Sigma and EFQM Excellence models can provide a whole systemic approach to performance appraisal and development at Normanton Lodge Care Home, incorporating many dimensions of care quality and operational performance.

Normanton Lodge will be able to pinpoint problems in the care process and remedy them using a Six Sigma model because it is statistical and data-driven (Hayes, 2024). It is about setting up problems in quality, monitoring performance, discovering root causes, applying focused improvement actions, and sustaining control (Hayes, 2024). This overall approach increases productivity and uniformity and, in turn, better care for the residents (Hayes, 2024).

The EFQM Success Model is a complete framework for long-term success that includes nine criteria: leadership, strategy, people, partnerships, processes, products/services, and customer, employee, and societal outcomes (Maline et al., 2023). It urges Normanton Lodge

to have a comprehensive quality approach, emphasising leadership and strategy to provide effective governance and clear standards.

The EFQM Excellence Model is likely a better fit for Normanton Lodge because it prioritises quality across people, processes, and societal effects, which aligns with the care home's objectives (Maline et al., 2023). Normanton Lodge can use the EFQM framework to continuously enhance resident happiness, staff engagement, and collaborations, guaranteeing equitable and effective care beyond financial metrics (Maline et al., 2023).

ISO 9001 in Healthcare

The ISO 9001 will provide a solid basis for the improvement of quality management in Normanton Lodge care home (Keen, 2024). If the nursing home would only adopt some standardised procedures, then the place would run more efficiently, the quality of care would be the same no matter who delivered it, and they would comply with all of the standards set forth by the healthcare industry (Keen, 2024).

It will provide for distinct quality goals, procedural standards, resident input, performance tracking, frequent audits, and staff education (Keen, 2024). With this organised way of thinking, not only does the care improve, but the mistakes decrease, and the residents have a better place to live.

ISO 9001 will assist the nursing home in having standardised resident care and safety procedures by having established policies, risk identification, detailed record keeping, and corrective action for non-conformance issues (Keen, 2024). This method fosters high-quality service and promotes continuous improvement (Keen, 2024).

Financial Modelling in Healthcare

Financial modelling entails the development of a spreadsheet to analyse company data and forecast outcomes (Kopp, 2024). This tool is utilised by executives and analysts to aid in planning and decision-making processes. Key components such as assumptions and financial statements play a role in ensuring predictions for future growth prospects (Kopp, 2024).

Normanton Lodge Care Home should do a CVP (Cost-Volume-Profit) analysis. Another thing that is calculated using CVP analysis is the contribution margin, that is, total sales minus total variable expenses (Kenton, 2024a). This margin must exceed all fixed costs for Normanton Lodge to remain a "going concern" able to furnish the exceptionally high-quality care that it does in an eco-friendly manner (kenton, 2024a).

CVP analysis, a tool used in TQM, enables Normanton Lodge Care Home to make better decisions. This, in turn, assists management in identifying areas of cost savings and maximising resource utilisation through the availability of profit margin and cost pattern data (Kenton, 2024a). With the use of this data-driven strategy, the finance worries will be aligned with the quality patient care goals to maintain operational sustainability, and that will foster continuous improvement (Kenton, 2024a).

Problem-Solving and Strategic Planning for Normanton Lodge Care Home

The long-term success of the Normanton Lodge Care Home requires sustainable profits, positive cash flow, and sound financial forecasting. Some of the main problem-solving methods are SWOT analysis, root cause analysis, and scenario planning, all of which are important to strategic planning and financial control (Moutinho et al., 2014). In addition to training its employees, the nursing home must strive to improve services, increase efficiency, and become more financially stable. These measures will bring the financial and operational aspects in line with its strategic objectives, allowing it to remain competitive and provide quality care for its residents (Moutinho et al., 2014).

Quality Improvement Plan for Healthcare Organisation

Quality improvement (QI) is a formalised method for dealing with problems in healthcare (Puri, 2023). This is a complex system incorporating many people with different backgrounds and skills, working in a social structure and using aids such as electronic medical records (Puri, 2023).

A maintenance plan in healthcare, particularly within a Total Quality Management (TQM) framework, is a systematic strategy to ensure that all hospital facilities, equipment, and systems are continually operating at their maximum effectiveness (Hidayah et al., 2022).

A good example of a maintenance plan for normanton lodge care home would be regular maintenance of medical and assistive equipment, including lifts, stairlifts, hoists, wheelchairs, and walking aids, which is critical for resident safety and freedom. Routine checks and maintenance keep equipment functioning and reliable for daily usage. This helps to maintain a high level of care while minimising disruptions.

Pareto analysis allows companies to determine what 20% of problems are causing 80% of the issues and then allocate the proper resources to these high-impact problems, increase productivity, and make problem-solving a much more streamlined process (Kenton, 2024b). The following table is the Pareto Analysis of Normanton Lodge Care Home.

Steps	Actions	Expected Outcome
1. Identify Problems	Collect data on issues: incidents, safeguarding, staffing, medication, infection control.	List of key issues affecting care quality.
2. List Causes	Identify causes for each issue (e.g., lack of training, oversight gaps).	Understanding of root causes.
3. Score Problems	Rank issues based on impact on safety, cost, and time.	Prioritized list of critical issues.
4. Group Problems	Categorize issues: Incident Review, Safeguarding, Medication, Staffing, Environment.	Organized view for targeted action.
5. Action Plan	Address high-priority areas: - Improve incident review, - Strengthen safeguarding, - Audit meds.	Resource focus on critical problems.
6. Create Pareto Chart	List problems by frequency/impact, create a bar chart to visualize top issues.	Visual tool for tracking improvement.

Table 2 – Pareto analysis of Normanton Lodge Care Home.

Adapted from Kenton (2024b).

Adapted from Author.

Six Sigma, created by Motorola in 1986, is a methodology for optimising business processes by reducing problems and increasing efficiency (Hayes, 2024). It uses the DMAIC approach (Define, Measure, Analyze, Improve, and Control) (Hayes, 2024). The following table is the Six Sigma Plan of Normanton Lodge Care Home.

DMAIC Phase	Actions	Expected Outcome
Define	Identify main issues: incident review, safeguarding, and medication processes.	Clear improvement goals.
Measure	Collect data on incidents, medication errors, and training.	Baseline understanding of current performance.
Analyze	Find root causes, such as lack of oversight and inconsistent reviews.	Clear insights into key issues.
Improve	Implement changes: regular reviews, enhanced training, and better medication protocols.	Fewer incidents and improved safety measures.
Control	Set up audits and feedback loops to maintain improvements.	Sustained process improvements and quality control.

Table 2 – Six Sigma Plan of Normanton Lodge Care Home.

Adapted from Hayes (2024).

Adapted from Author.

Improvement Plan

SMART goals are an approach to defining specific, measurable, attainable, relevant, and time-bound objectives. This framework assists in ensuring that goals are defined, trackable, and realistic within a certain timeframe. An example of SMART objectives for the care home could be:

S: Introduce two group activities.
M: Increase participation by 20%.
A: Activities coordinator and staff.
R: Improve resident well-being.
T: Launch in 3 months.

Aspect	What does Normanton Lodge Care Home do?	What needs to be improved?	How can we improve?	How will we measure success?
Systems	Provides care and safety assessments for residents	Needs a better system for managing quality	Implement an electronic quality management system (eQMS)	Fewer errors in documentation and faster access to records
Processes	Manages daily care and medication for residents	Care documentation is inconsistent	Standardize how care is recorded and reported	Fewer mistakes in care notes and timely incident reports
Flow	Coordinates staff and resources for resident care	Slow response to incidents	Improve communication among staff	Faster response times to incidents
Variation	Offers personalized care to residents	Care quality varies between staff	Provide regular training for all staff	Consistent satisfaction scores from residents

Table 4 – TQM Gap Analysis and Quality Improvement Plan for Normanton Lodge Care Home.

Adapted from Author.

TQM Stage	What do we want to achieve?	How will we do it?	When and how will we measure?
Leadership Commitment	Get management support for quality improvement	Hold regular meetings to discuss quality initiatives	Track engagement in meetings quarterly
Cultural Change	Create a focus on resident care and quality	Conduct workshops to educate staff on TQM principles	Measure staff feedback and participation biannually
Focus on Residents	Prioritize residents' needs and satisfaction	Collect feedback from residents and families	Monthly surveys to gauge satisfaction and complaints
Staff Empowerment	Encourage staff to share ideas and concerns	Set up suggestion boxes and open forums for feedback	Track number of suggestions and staff engagement quarterly
Continuous Improvement	Make ongoing improvements a regular practice	Use the PDSA cycle for testing changes	Conduct biannual reviews to measure improvements
Staff Training	Ensure staff have the right skills	Offer regular training sessions on care practices	Monitor attendance and assess skills after training
Teamwork	Improve collaboration among staff	Form teams to tackle specific issues	Evaluate project outcomes and gather team feedback

Table 5 – Stages of TQM Implementation and Key Performance Indicators for Normanton Lodge Care Home.

Adapted from Author.

Normanton Lodge Care Home achieves continual quality improvement by incorporating Total Quality Management (TQM) principles into its daily operations. By focusing on customer satisfaction, they ensure that resident and family needs are satisfied through frequent feedback and prompt action (Stanton, 2021). Leadership commitment promotes a quality-focused culture by empowering employees via training and encouragement (Stanton, 2021). Key performance indicators (KPIs) are monitored to identify areas for improvement, and standardised methods increase consistency (Stanton, 2021). Employee involvement is encouraged through open communication, regular audits, and self-assessment, which all contribute to the maintenance of high standards (Stanton, 2021).

This complete approach establishes Normanton Lodge as a premier care home committed to quality.

Conclusion

Total Quality Management (TQM) concepts must be used at Normanton Lodge Care Home to enhance care quality and resident outcomes continually. Despite present capabilities in infection control, medication management, and personalised care, deficiencies in governance, safeguarding, and communication persist. Addressing these concerns with organized quality frameworks such as Lean Six Sigma, the PDSA cycle, and ISO 9001 can assist the facility in creating a safer, more efficient, and resident-centered care environment. Leadership commitment, staff participation, and frequent suggestions from residents and families are critical to sustaining and improving quality standards.

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